Ahmedabad and Toronto Public Libraries

Falling use, a lifetime-heavy roll, and the gap between proximity and a public

Right 2 Read Campaign

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Abstract

We compare the Ahmedabad Public Library / M.J. Library Network with the Toronto Public Library on standardized IFLA Library Map of the World indicators — service points, collections, registered users, visits, loans, and finance — each normalized by population. The two systems disclose unequally. Ahmedabad publishes a decade of annual operations and finance tables and a new ward-centroid walk-access proxy; Toronto publishes current branch locations, square footage, visits, borrowing, registrations, and finance, but median-resident travel time is not yet computed.

The central finding is internal to Ahmedabad: its public use is not low and stable, it is falling. Annual circulation fell 55 percent, from 212,397 in 2017-18 to 96,491 in 2025-26. New annual members fell 84 percent, from 3,194 in 2018-19 to 505 in 2025-26. The reported total of 26,834 members is nearly flat across the decade only because 95 percent of it is a lifetime roll that never expires; the active share is below 2 percent. On the one cleanly matched indicator, Toronto lends about 735 times more per resident (10.02 against 0.014 borrowings). We use Toronto as a disclosure standard, not a fairness benchmark: even at Toronto's far higher per-resident spending, the use gap is several times the spending gap, so funding levels alone do not explain Ahmedabad's decline. A budget that allocates 61.7 percent to establishment and 1.4 percent to materials explains more of it.

Literature Review and Conceptual Frame

A public library is not a list of buildings, so a branch count can make a weak system look healthy. The measurement literature separates inputs (collections, staff, spending), outputs (visits, loans, registrations), and outcomes (use, access, inclusion). The IFLA Library Map of the World, built on ISO 2789 definitions, gives the indicator grammar we use: service points, registered users, visits, physical and digital loans, staff, internet access, and collections, all comparable per population (International Federation of Library Associations and Institutions 2026; ISO 2789 2022). ISO 11620 adds the performance question — not how much a library owns, but how well its resources convert into use (ISO 11620 2023). That distinction organizes this paper. The library is best read as civic infrastructure, not a book warehouse — provisioned, sited, and judged like other urban systems (Mattern 2014). Ahmedabad's collection disclosure is strong; its use is not.

The normative baseline is shared. The IFLA-UNESCO Public Library Manifesto frames the public library as a local institution for education, information, and civic life (International Federation of Library Associations and Institutions and UNESCO 2022), close to Ranganathan's user-centred laws: books are for use, every reader their book, every book its reader, save the reader's time (Ranganathan 1931). Both make circulation, visits, hours, and collection renewal the primary measures. The urban-sociology literature explains why use, not stock, is the test: libraries work as low-threshold public space and social infrastructure, anchoring everyday public life beyond lending (Oldenburg 1989; Audunson 2005; Klinenberg 2018), though the link to trust and social capital must be shown, not assumed (Goulding 2004; Vårheim et al. 2008). In the Indian debate the same point recurs as a politics of neglect: the public library is named a bedrock of democratic and anti-caste life (Liang and Gupta 2024) yet left under-resourced by the states that own it (Chitralekha 2014; Pyati 2009), inside cities where elected municipal bodies hold limited control (Mehta 2016). And "access" is not the end of the argument — a library can be nominally available and still go unused, or remain exclusionary in practice (Mickiewicz 2016).

Access is not distance. Penchansky and Thomas distinguish availability, accessibility, accommodation, affordability, and acceptability (Penchansky and Thomas 1981); spatial-accessibility work shows a defensible model needs demand origins, supply capacity, travel time, catchments, and distance decay, not nearest-facility distance alone (Guagliardo 2004; Luo and Wang 2003; Luo and Qi 2009); the nearest-facility assumption that simpler proxies rest on is itself only an approximation of how people travel (Nisar et al. 2018). We therefore read the Ahmedabad ward-centroid walk model as a first diagnostic, not an accessibility finding. On where a library should go, the IFLA service guidelines are explicit: service points belong where people already converge, with branch, deposit, and mobile service tiered outward so that everyone in the area is reached (IFLA Public Library Section 2010). In the Indian policy context (National Knowledge Commission 2007), the binding constraint on comparison is municipal disclosure; Ahmedabad is unusual in disclosing a decade-long series at all, which is what lets us measure decline rather than infer it.

We carry five measurement rules into the analysis: normalize by population; separate service points from effective capacity; treat public funding as an input, not a result; read user fees as a possible barrier even when fiscally minor; and keep spatial access as a proxy until travel-time routing is built.

Data and Methods

The unit of analysis is the municipal public-library system, not a flagship branch. Ahmedabad is the **Ahmedabad Public Library / M.J. Library Network**; "M.J. Library" denotes only the flagship.

We build the comparison from each system's own disclosures, normalized to common units. For Ahmedabad we use the M.J. Network's annual proactive (RTI) disclosures, 2015-16 to 2025-26, for collections, membership, and circulation, and its annual budget disclosures for finance. For Toronto we use the city's open-data branch file, the 2024 published key facts, and the 2026 library finance page. We convert counts to per-resident or per-100,000-resident rates with a fixed population denominator for each city —

Ahmedabad 7,078,533 (2020 ward population), Toronto 2,794,356 (2021 census) — stated here so readers can rescale.

We separate matched from partial indicators. A matched indicator is one both systems report on a comparable basis. A partial indicator is reported by one system, or on bases too different to divide; we keep it to mark a gap, not to form a ratio. Where a ratio would pair non-comparable objects, we report "not comparable" rather than a number. Finance years differ (Ahmedabad 2025-26, Toronto 2026) because we use each system's latest locally normalized values; this moves levels, not orders of magnitude. The Ahmedabad spatial-access measure is a ward-centroid, population-weighted walk-time proxy over 48 wards and 83 geocoded locations; it is not scheduled-transit routing and understates within-ward inequality. Toronto's matching median-resident routing is not yet computed.

All figures are produced from these source tables by `scripts/make_library_paper_figures.py`. The full source inventory is in the appendix.

Results: System Denominators

Measure	Ahmedabad Public Library / M.J. Library Network	Toronto Public Library
Population denominator	7,078,533	2,794,356
Denominator year	2020 ward population	2021 census
Service points	83 geocoded locations	102 branches/bookmobiles
Coordinate-verified records	83	101
Collection items	811,093	at least 10,500,000
Latest operations year used	2025-26	2024
Latest finance year used	2025-26	2026

The Toronto denominator is deliberately conservative for this draft. It uses the 2021 City of Toronto census population because that value is stable and sourceable inside the current work. If Toronto's 2026 population is higher, Toronto's per-resident library metrics will fall, but not enough to change the order of magnitude gap reported below.

Ahmedabad's denominator is the Right 2 Read Campaign ward-population total used in the Ahmedabad library access model. It is also not a 2026 population estimate, so the same caution applies in the other direction.

Results: IFLA-Aligned Indicators

Indicator	Ahmedabad	Toronto	Toronto/Ahmedabad	Comparability
Service points per 100,000 residents	1.173	3.650	3.11x	High
Collection items per 1,000 residents	114.6	3,758	32.79x	Medium
Registered member share of residents	0.379%	not normalized		Partial

Indicator	Ahmedabad	Toronto	Toronto/Ahmedabad	Comparability
Annual member/card registration flow per 100,000 residents	7.134	8,419	not comparable	Partial
Borrowings/circulation per resident	0.014	10.02	735.08x	Medium
Branch visits per resident	not disclosed	4.795		Partial
Median walk time to nearest library	14.5 minutes	not computed		Partial
Reading/library materials share of operating budget	1.438%	7.797%	5.42x	Medium
Own-income or fines/fees revenue share	3.70%	1.452%	0.39x	Medium

Three things stand out.

First, Toronto's public-library footprint is denser. Using service points per 100,000 residents, Toronto has 3.11 times Ahmedabad's service-point density even before any transit-routing advantage is measured.

Second, Toronto's collection stock is far deeper per resident. The Toronto value is conservative because the source states more than 10.5 million items; the table uses exactly 10.5 million. Even then, Toronto has about 32.8 times more collection items per resident.

Third, the use gap is not marginal. Ahmedabad reports 96,491 annual circulation in 2025-26, or 0.014 circulations per resident. Toronto reports 28 million borrowings in 2024, or 10.02 borrowings per resident. That is the 735x gap. The formats are not perfectly identical, but the difference is too large to be a classification artifact.

One row in the table is deliberately left without a ratio. Ahmedabad's "annual members" is a membership *tier* in the M.J. Network disclosures, not a count of new users; Toronto's "new card registrations" is a genuine new-user inflow. These are different objects, so dividing one by the other would manufacture a ratio with no defensible meaning. Both values are kept because each is informative on its own — Toronto registers more new cards per 100,000 residents in a single year than Ahmedabad has active annual members in total — but the pairing is reported as not comparable rather than as a number.

Ahmedabad: Proximity, Decline, and a Lifetime-Heavy Roll

Ahmedabad's new ward-level proxy does not show a total desert. It estimates a population-weighted median walk time of 14.5 minutes to the nearest geocoded public-library location. It also estimates 41.9 percent of residents within 10 minutes, 51.8 percent within 15 minutes, and 68.5 percent within 30 minutes.

But the outcome indicators are weak:

Ahmedabad Public Library / M.J. Library Network, 2025-26	Value
Collection items	811,093
New additions	4,859
Registered network members	26,834
Annual members	505
Lifetime members	25,574
Annual circulation	96,491
Membership penetration	0.379%
Residents per registered member	263.8

The key reading is that physical or nominal proximity is not becoming system use. A city can have branch points and still fail to produce active public-library demand if hours, staffing, discoverability, borrowing rules, materials, program design, reading-room access, transport connection, or trust are weak.

The member structure matters. The 2025-26 disclosure is lifetime-heavy: 25,574 of 26,834 members are lifetime members. Annual members are only 505. That is not how a growing mass public system should look. It suggests a legacy membership roll with weak current inflow.

The decade trend: a system in decline

The single-year snapshot understates the problem. Read as a 2015-16 to 2025-26 series, the M.J. Network's own disclosures show use falling, not holding steady (Figure 1).

The values are in the table below.

Year	Circulation	Annual (active) members	Lifetime members
2015-16	193,138	1,655	19,109
2016-17	207,360	2,465	20,907
2017-18	**212,397**	2,823	21,496
2018-19	194,822	**3,194**	22,114
2019-20	188,175	2,620	24,575
2020-21	162,323	1,098	23,146
2021-22	89,846	263	23,447
2022-23	75,814	**152**	23,544
2023-24	91,139	529	23,949
2024-25	96,115	389	25,332
2025-26	96,491	505	25,574

Three movements run through this table.

First, circulation collapsed and did not recover. It peaked at 212,397 in 2017-18 and stands at 96,491 in 2025-26, a fall of about 55 percent. The decline begins before the pandemic, accelerates sharply in 2021-22, and then flattens at a new floor near half the former level. This is a step-down, not a dip.

Second, the inflow of new active users almost stopped. Annual members peaked at 3,194 in 2018-19, fell to 152 in 2022-23, and have only partly recovered to 505. That is an 84 percent fall from the peak. A public library that signs up roughly 500 active members a year in a city of seven million is not recruiting the public; it is being visited by a residual base.

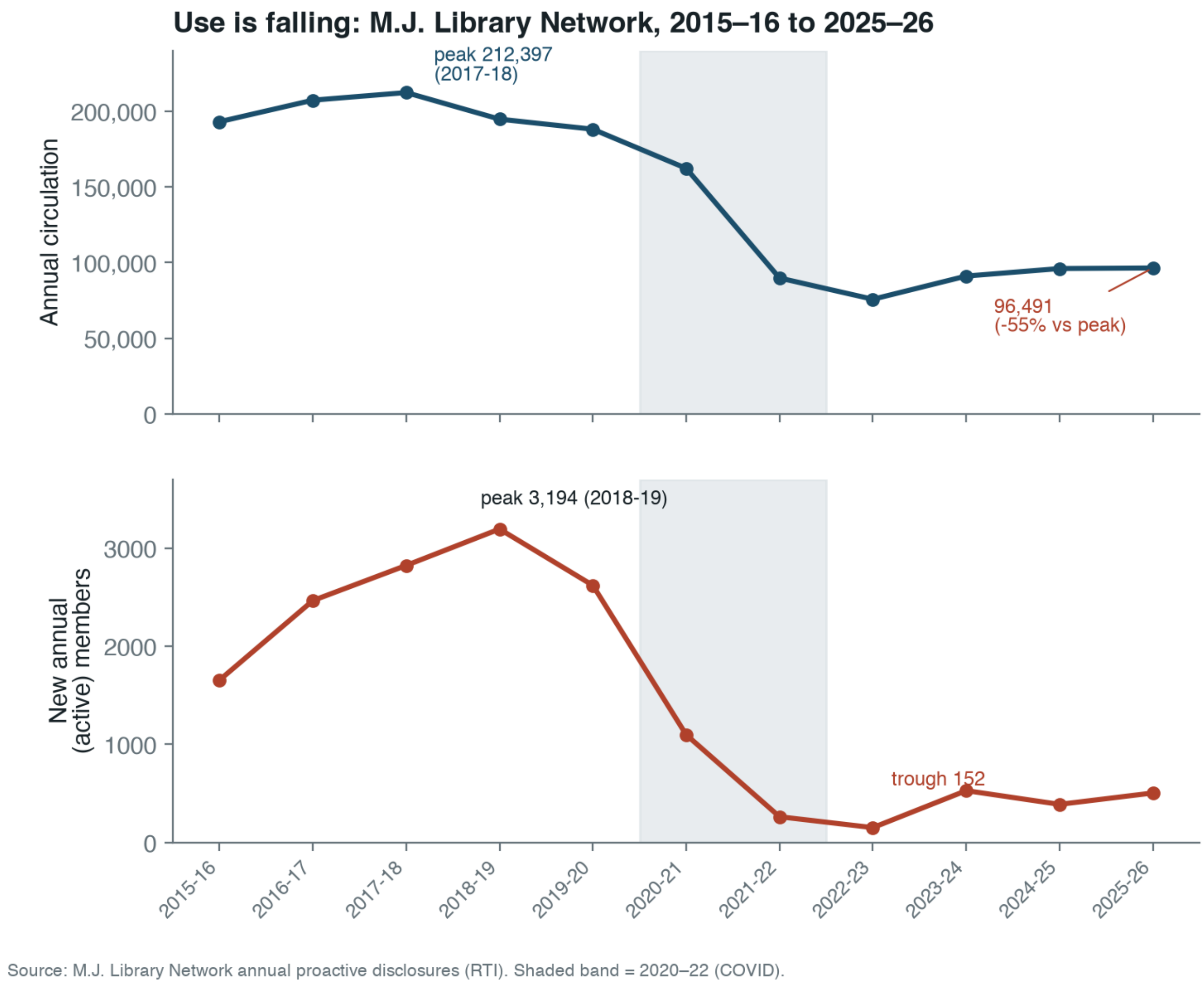

Figure 1: Annual circulation and new active membership, M.J. Library Network, 2015-16 to 2025-26. Circulation peaks in 2017-18 and settles near half that level; new annual members fall by 84 percent from their 2018-19 peak.

Third, the headline membership total is an accounting artifact. Lifetime members grew from 19,109 to 25,574 across the decade, because a lifetime member is never removed from the roll. They are now about 95 percent of the reported total. The "26,834 members" figure is stable not because the system is healthy but because a permanent roll masks the fall in active membership; the active share is under two percent (Figure 2).

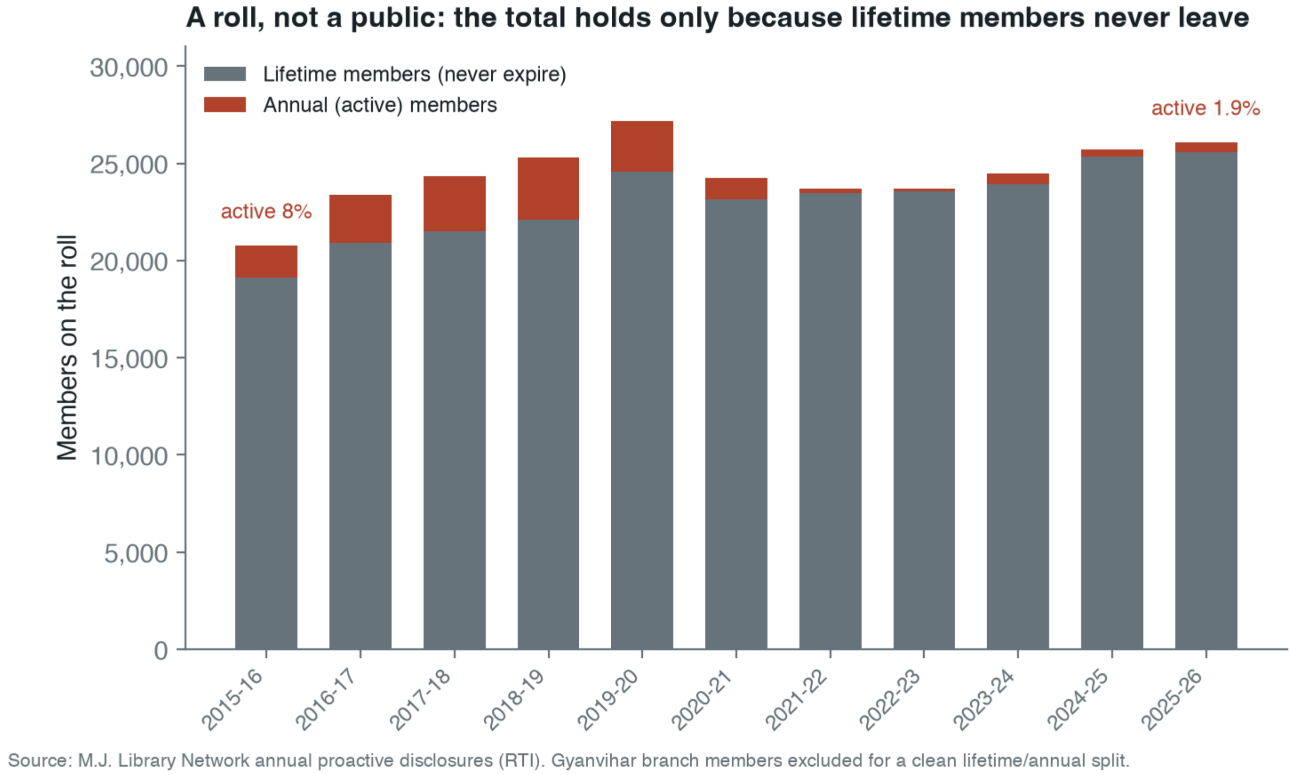

Figure 2: Members on the roll, by type. The total is roughly flat because lifetime members accumulate and never leave, while the active (annual) share falls from 8 percent to under 2 percent.

This reframes the access question. The first diagnostic was that proximity was not converting into use. The decade series sharpens it: this is a legacy subscription-style institution whose active public has been shrinking for years, while its public-funding share and its lifetime roll both stay high. Naming the system after its nineteenth-century flagship is not only a labelling problem; it describes what the institution has functionally remained.

Toronto: Network Density and High Throughput

Toronto Public Library's official branch feed contains 112 service records. The normalized Right 2 Read Campaign output identifies 100 physical branches, 101 records with usable coordinates, and 1,993,863 square feet across physical branches. TPL's official 2024 key facts report 100 branches and two bookmobiles, at least 10.5 million collection items, 13.4 million branch visits, 31.5 million online-platform visits, 28 million borrowings, and 235,270 new card registrations.

On standardized denominators:

Toronto Public Library metric	Value
Physical branches	100
Branches plus bookmobiles	102
Branch square footage	1,993,863 sq ft
Branch square feet per 1,000 residents	713.5

Toronto Public Library metric	Value
Borrowings per resident	10.02
Branch visits per resident	4.795
New card registrations per 100,000 residents	8,419

The Toronto branch-square-footage metric has no Ahmedabad equivalent yet. That is an important next extraction target. Ahmedabad needs area, reading-seat capacity, opening hours, staff, and program availability for every branch if we want to move from a location count to actual service capacity.

Finance: Both Publicly Funded, But Different Public Value

Ahmedabad Public Library / M.J. Library Network is overwhelmingly AMC-funded. In 2025-26 it reports a total budget of Rs 22.7675 crore, an AMC grant of Rs 21.9255 crore, and library income of Rs 0.8420 crore. AMC therefore funds 96.30 percent of the reported budget, while the library-income line is only 3.70 percent.

Toronto Public Library's 2026 finance page reports CAD 296.057 million gross expenditure. City funding through property taxes is CAD 274.378 million, or 92.68 percent. Revenues labelled fines/fees are CAD 4.298 million, or 1.45 percent.

Finance measure	Ahmedabad	Toronto
Public funding share	96.30%	92.68%
Own-income or fines/fees share	3.70%	1.45%
Materials share of operating budget	1.44%	7.80%

This changes the interpretation of user fees. Ahmedabad's disclosed own-income share is higher than Toronto's fines/fees share, but it is still far too small to fund the system. Fees are not the operating model. In practice they function as an administrative gate and a rationing device inside an already publicly funded system. If the goal is IFLA-style public reach, the policy question is not how to raise more user fees. The question is how a 96 percent municipally funded system can convert public subsidy into far more members, visits, borrowing, and reading activity.

The materials line is more damaging. Ahmedabad spends 1.44 percent of the 2025-26 total budget on reading material. Toronto's 2026 Library Materials line is 7.80 percent of gross expenditure. This is not a perfect same-year or same classification comparison, but it is directionally important. A public library network cannot generate high use if the public sees slow collection renewal and weak branch-level availability.

The internal composition of Ahmedabad's own budget shows why. The 2025-26 disclosure spends Rs 14.0415 crore on establishment and payroll and Rs 0.3275 crore on reading material — 61.7 percent and 1.4 percent of the total, a ratio of about 43 to 1 (Figure 3).

A budget that puts nearly two-thirds into establishment and under two percent into books is funding the institution's continuity rather than its collection. This is the fiscal counterpart of the membership finding: the system is preserved as a public establishment while the reading service it exists to deliver is starved. The decline in circulation is not mysterious if the public encounters thin and slowly renewed shelves.

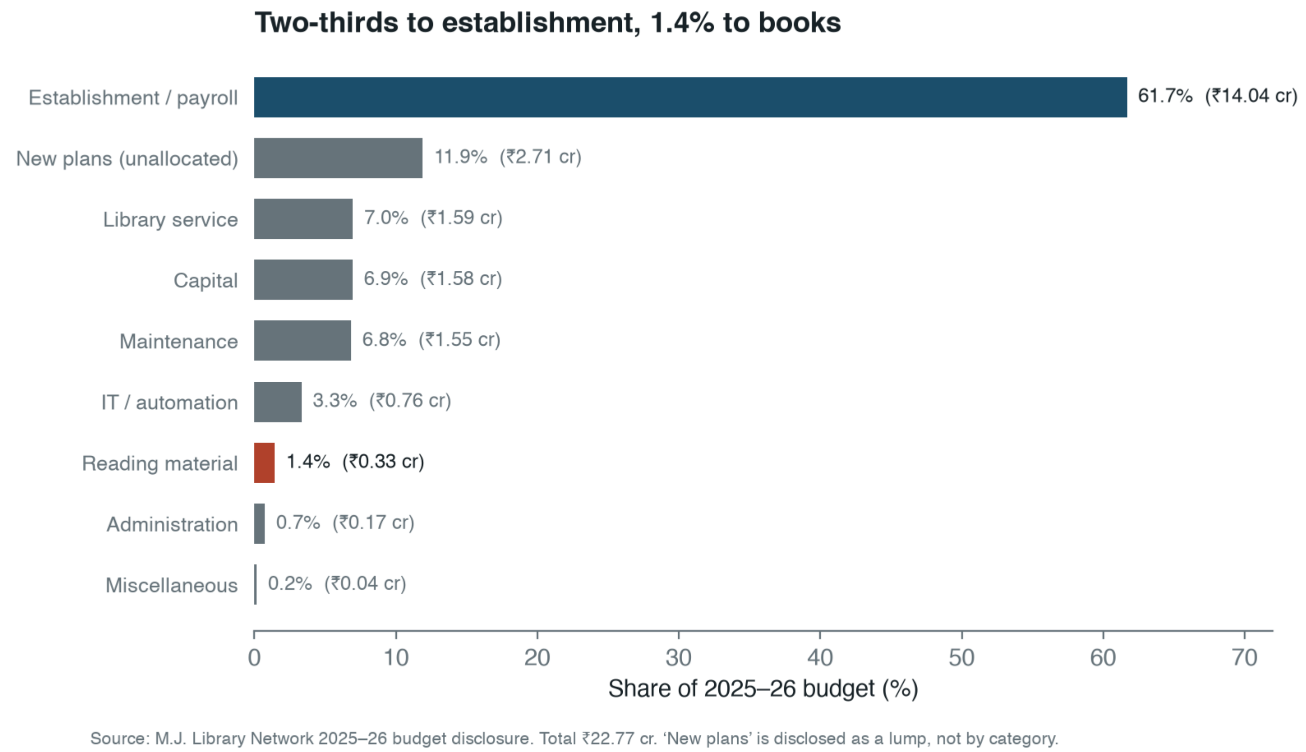

Figure 3: Ahmedabad Public Library / M.J. Library Network, 2025-26 budget by category. Establishment and payroll take 61.7 percent; reading material takes 1.4 percent. Total budget Rs 22.77 crore.

Reading the Comparison: A Use Gap Larger Than the Money Gap

Toronto is far better resourced, and it would be easy to stop there: a wealthy global-North city outspends a mid-budget Indian one, so of course it lends more. That reading is comfortable and wrong, because it treats the use gap as a simple echo of the money gap. The numbers do not let it.

Normalize spending the same way the rest of this paper normalizes everything else, per resident. Ahmedabad's 2025-26 budget is about Rs 32 per resident. Toronto's 2026 budget is about CAD 106 per resident. At a nominal rate of roughly CAD 1 to Rs 60 — stated here as an explicit, replaceable assumption, not a sourced exchange rate — Toronto spends on the order of 200 times more per resident than Ahmedabad. Yet Toronto borrows about 735 times more per resident. The use gap is therefore roughly three to four times wider than even the nominal per-resident spending gap, and purchasing-power adjustment, which narrows the money gap, would widen the unexplained remainder further.

The point of the comparison is not the size of Toronto's budget. It is that money alone does not account for Ahmedabad's under-use. A system spending two-thirds of its budget on establishment and under two percent on books, signing up about 500 active members a year, and watching circulation fall by half over a decade would under-perform its funding at any exchange rate. Toronto is useful here as a disclosure standard — it shows which IFLA-style fields a functioning municipal library reports and reaches — not as a fairness benchmark a mid-budget Indian system is being scored against.

Access: What Is Computed and What Is Not

Ahmedabad has a computed access proxy:

Ahmedabad access metric	Value
Ward origins	48
Library locations	83

Ahmedabad access metric	Value
Transit stops in proxy model	237
Median walk time to nearest library	14.5 minutes
75th percentile walk time	31.6 minutes
90th percentile walk time	53.4 minutes
Population within 30 minutes walking	68.5%

The proxy is uneven across the city (Figure 4). Walk time to the nearest library is short in the central wards, where the historic branches sit, and long on the industrial periphery: Maktampura (80 minutes), Lambha (76), Chandlodia (59), Sarkhej (53), and Ramol Hathijan (44) are the worst-served, and these are also among the most populous outer wards.

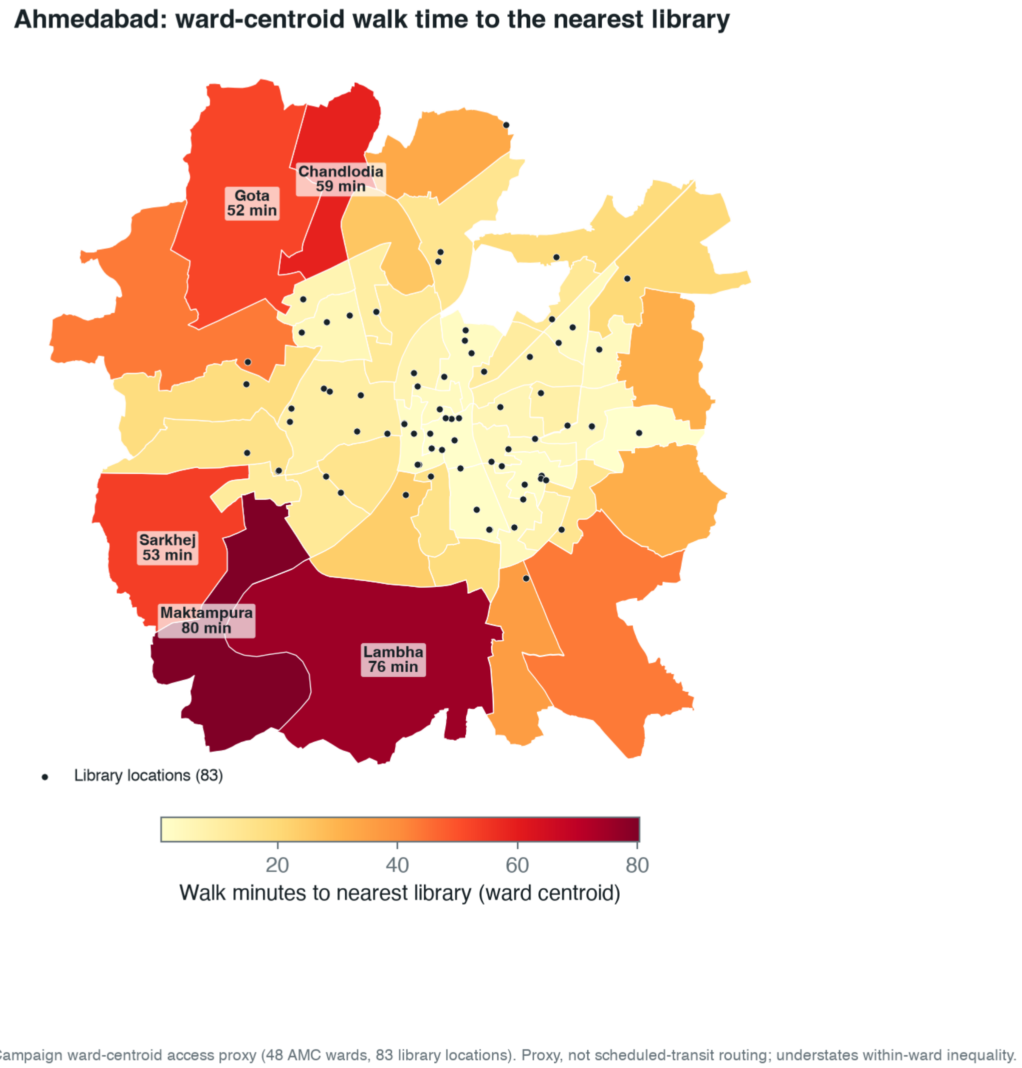

Figure 4: Ward-centroid walk time to the nearest of 83 library locations, 48 AMC wards. Central wards are well covered; the industrial periphery is not.

This is a ward-centroid model, not scheduled-transit routing. It understates within-ward inequality and cannot answer the median-resident-by-actual-travel-time question. Still, it gives a first diagnostic, and it points two ways at once. Spatial absence is real on the periphery. But the central wards have short walk times and the city still records very low membership and circulation, so distance is not the whole story: a network with many mapped locations is producing little disclosed use.

Transit reaches the periphery; libraries do not

Walking is not the only way to a library, so we checked the city's three public transit modes — the Metro, the Janmarg/AJL bus-rapid-transit (BRTS) corridors, and the AMTS bus network — against the library map (Figure 5). The access model also carries a scheduled-transit time, but it is a crude proxy that adds a fixed wait and transfer penalty; in it the bus never beats walking to a library in any of the 48 wards, which is an artefact of the proxy, not a finding. We therefore do not report transit travel times. What the network geometry shows, with no routing assumption, is a siting problem.

The rapid-transit network already reaches the underserved periphery. A Metro or BRTS corridor runs through every one of the worst-served wards — Maktampura, Lambha, Sarkhej, Gota, Ramol Hathijan, Vatva, Thaltej — the same wards that sit 40 to 80 minutes' walk from a library. The libraries are what is missing: only 60 of 83 are within 500 m of a Metro or BRTS corridor, and 23 are not near rapid transit at all. Almost every library is near an AMTS bus stop (74 of 83 within 300 m), so the periphery is not unreachable. The public-library network was simply not built along the high-capacity lines that already serve these wards.

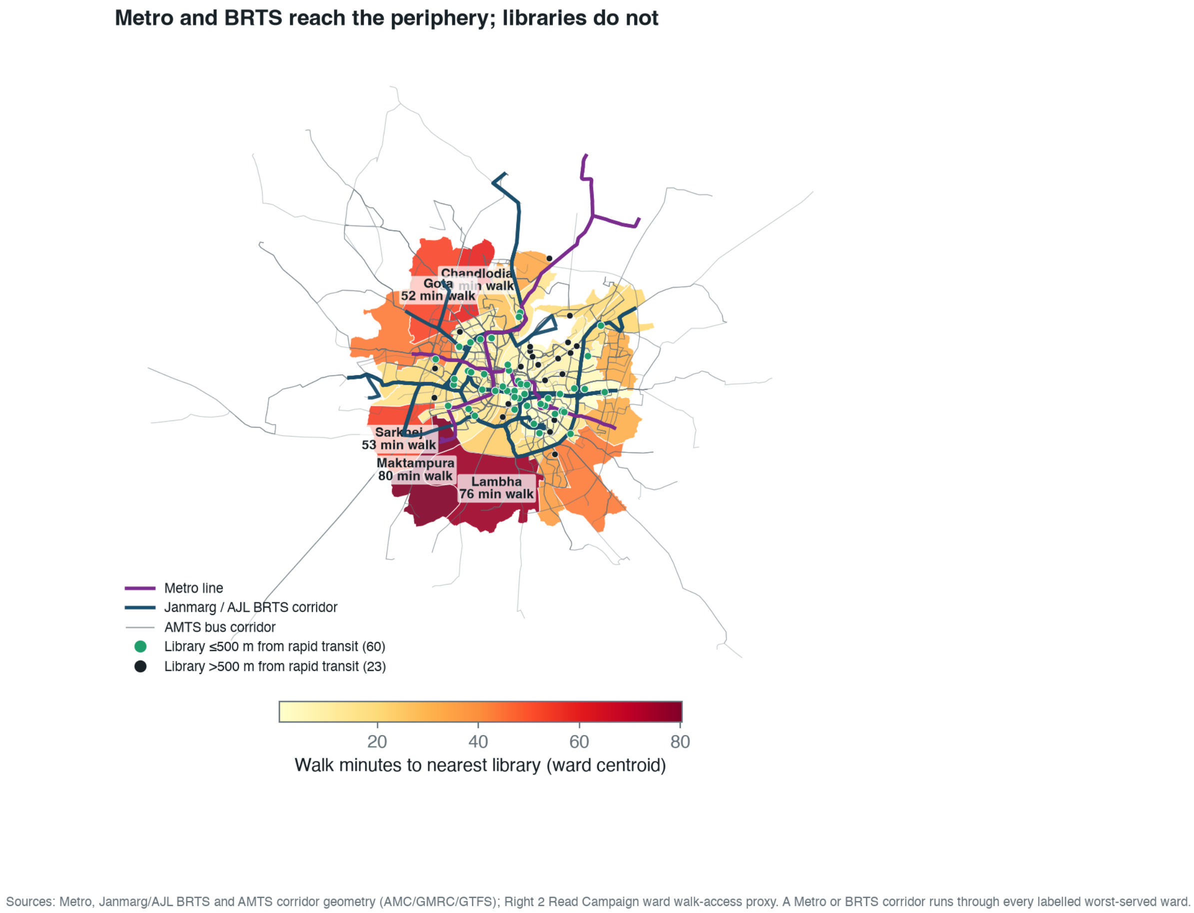

Figure 5: Walk time to the nearest library (ward fill) against the Metro, Janmarg/AJL BRTS, and AMTS networks. A Metro or BRTS corridor runs through every labelled worst-served ward, yet 23 of 83 libraries are not near rapid transit and the peripheral wards on the lines have no library within reach.

Cities elsewhere now plan for exactly this proximity. The "15-minute city" and, since 2016, China's older "15-minute community life circle" — first issued in Shanghai — require daily public facilities, libraries among them, to fall within a short walk, and then audit that coverage as a governance metric (Yang and Qian 2024; Ma et al. 2023). The recurring deficit those audits report is the suburban periphery, the same place Ahmedabad's library access fails. Proximity to a line is also not yet access: the first- and last-mile stretches, the waiting and the transfers, are where the trip actually breaks down, especially for women (Roy et al. 2024).

Relative to the other problems in this paper, this one is cheap to fix. Putting branch service — even small reading rooms or extension counters — on the Metro and BRTS corridors that already pass through Lambha, Maktampura, Sarkhej, Vatva, and Ramol Hathijan would turn existing transit investment into library access without waiting for new roads or new routing.

Toronto does not yet have a matching median-resident routing model in this branch. The TPL location and capacity layer is ready. The next Toronto step is to join population origins and TTC routes/walk access so the atlas can compare median-resident convenience directly.

Data Gaps Under the IFLA Frame

The present Ahmedabad disclosure still lacks several IFLA-style fields:

- physical visits;
- e-book loans;
- audiobook loans;
- downloads and digital-resource use;
- full-time staff;
- volunteers;
- internet-access points;
- branch hours and reading-seat capacity by location.

Toronto is stronger but still not complete inside this branch:

- registered-user stock is not normalized from a current official local source;
- median-resident access by walking and TTC routing is pending;
- branch-level usage is not joined to branch square footage, hours, and neighbourhood population.

These gaps are not cosmetic. They are the difference between a library as a building list and a library as a public service system.

Implications for Ahmedabad

For Ahmedabad, the first policy conclusion is that Ahmedabad Public Library / M.J. Library Network should be treated as a citywide public-library system, not as only the M.J. Library flagship plus scattered branch assets. Naming matters because governance follows the object being named. If the object is only the flagship, the analysis will over-focus on a historic institution. If the object is the city network, the question becomes coverage, use, renewal, hours, staffing, and public accountability across all wards.

The second conclusion is that user fees are a distraction as a funding strategy. Ahmedabad's own-income line is a small budget share and may include more than fees. Removing or reducing fee barriers would have a small direct revenue cost relative to the AMC grant, but could matter for membership conversion.

The third conclusion is that materials and branch service quality need to be measured location by location. A service point that is open briefly, poorly stocked, hard to discover, or weakly connected to transit should not be counted as equivalent to a full-service branch.

The fourth conclusion follows from the decade series and the budget split. The metric that matters is not the reported member total, which the lifetime roll will keep flattering, but the annual inflow of active members and annual circulation, both of which the system already discloses and both of which are falling. A credible turnaround target would be stated against those two series and funded by shifting the budget mix away from an establishment share above 60 percent and toward the materials, hours, and branch-staffing lines that produce use. The disclosures needed to track this exist; the question is whether the system is managed to the use indicators or only to its grant.

Next Work

Two extensions would close the main gaps in this comparison:

- branch-level capacity for Ahmedabad — square footage, seats, opening hours, staff, per-branch collection, reading-room capacity, digital access, and program facilities — so a location count becomes a measure of service capacity;
- a median-resident access model for Toronto on the same basis as Ahmedabad, joining branch locations, TTC and walk access, and population origins, so the two cities' physical access can be compared directly rather than only their use.

Conclusion

Ahmedabad Public Library / M.J. Library Network is not merely underfunded relative to Toronto Public Library. Its sharper problem is internal and longitudinal: over a decade its own disclosures show circulation falling by about 55 percent, annual active membership collapsing by about 84 percent, and a reported member total held stable only by a lifetime roll that is now 95 percent of the count. A budget that spends 61.7 percent on establishment and 1.4 percent on books explains the starved collection behind that decline. The system is under-converting public funding, collection stock, and mapped locations into public use — and the conversion is getting worse, not holding steady.

Toronto sets the disclosure standard against which this shows up clearly: 3.11 times the service-point density, at least 32.8 times the collection depth per resident, and roughly 735 times the borrowing per resident, a use gap several times larger than even the per-resident money gap. Ahmedabad's 96.30 percent AMC funding share means the system is already public in fiscal form. The gap is that it is not yet public enough in use, and on present trend it is becoming less so.

The practical target for Ahmedabad is therefore not a better flagship story. It is a citywide Ahmedabad Public Library standard: branches that are visible, reachable, open, stocked, staffed, free or near-free to join, and measured every year on IFLA-aligned public-use indicators.

Appendix: Source Inventory and Reproducibility Notes

The comparison is built from local Right 2 Read Campaign source tables and official public web sources preserved into normalized files.

Locations and access

- Ahmedabad: `data/cities/ahmedabad/source/libraries/ahmedabad_library_locations.csv`; `data/cities/ahmedabad/derived/library_access/`
- Toronto: `data/cities/toronto/source/libraries/tpl_branch_general_information_4326.csv`; `data/cities/toronto/derived/library_access/`

Transit network (Ahmedabad)

- Metro: `data/cities/ahmedabad/layers/metro_lines.geojson`; `data/cities/ahmedabad/layers/metro.`
- Janmarg / AJL BRTS: `data/cities/ahmedabad/layers/corr_brts.geojson`
- AMTS: `data/cities/ahmedabad/layers/corr_amts.geojson`; `data/cities/ahmedabad/layers/stops.ge`

Operations

- Ahmedabad: `data/cities/ahmedabad/source/libraries/mj_library_annual_stats.csv`
- Toronto: `data/cities/toronto/source/libraries/tpl_key_facts_2024.json`

Finance

- Ahmedabad: `data/cities/ahmedabad/source/libraries/mj_library_finance.csv`
- Toronto: `data/cities/toronto/source/libraries/tpl_finance_2026.json`

Comparator outputs

- `data/comparators/ahmedabad_toronto/ifla_metric_comparison.csv`
- `data/comparators/ahmedabad_toronto/library_system_comparison.csv`

The IFLA frame is used as an indicator grammar, not as a claim that every field has a single universal target. The paper therefore separates matched indicators from partial indicators. Where a city does not disclose a metric, the absence is kept as a data gap rather than inferred.

Official web references used for this draft include the IFLA Library Map of the World, Toronto Open Data's Library Branch General Information package, Toronto Public Library's About page and Library Finance page, and the official M.J. Library site (International Federation of Library Associations and Institutions 2026; City of Toronto Open Data 2026; Toronto Public Library 2026a, 2026b; M.J. Library 2026).

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